# Implement virtual field support with a JSON storage #8838

Open **fritzmg** wants to merge 25 commits into `contao:5.x` from `fritzmg:feature/virtual-dca-fields`

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**fritzmg** commented last week • edited — Member

Implements #8791

This allows you to define fields in any (database based) DCA without an `sql` storage. Instead, the data of these fields will be stored together in one single `json` data column automatically. For example:

```
// contao/dca/tl_content.php
$GLOBALS['TL_DCA']['tl_content']['fields']['foobar'] = [
    'inputType' => 'text',
];
```

When not defining more than this, the field will automatically be stored in `jsonData`, which can then be decoded in your controller.

In your controller you can then access that DCA field seamlessly via the model instance, as the model will automatically decode the storage (once) for you and return the stored value:

```
$model->foobar
```

Reviewers


Toflar


leofeyer

Requested changes n
this pull request.

Still in progress? Con

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fritzmg

Labels

feature

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None yet

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